Summit Fellowship — 2027 application

This is an offline copy of the online application, for drafting. Applications are only accepted through the online form at /apply/form — paste your answers in when you are ready. Character limits below are hard limits online.

Before you start, gather:

- Your active user count today, and your own definition of "active".
- The month and year the first person outside your organisation used what you built.
- Your three largest delivery sites or partners, with users today and start dates.
- Your primary outcome metric and how you measure it.
- Your single best outcome result: the number, the sample, who measured it and when.

G3 (the path to 1M users) is the one long answer — plan five to eight minutes for it.

Eligibility (answer yes or no)

[ ] Yes [ ] No Are you the founder, or the senior-most leader with real decision-making power?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Are you the founder of the organisation?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Is your organisation past the pilot stage, with real delivery or reach numbers from the last 12 months?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Is your annual budget at least USD 100,000?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Do you have basic financial systems in place (audited statements or equivalent)?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Are you fluent in English?

[ ] Yes [ ] No Can you spend seven consecutive days fully present — no email or calls during sessions?

Section A — Organisation

A1. Organisation name
Legal registered name.
Max 100 characters.

A2. Name you operate under, if different (optional)
Leave blank if the same.
Max 100 characters.

A3. Organisation type
[ ] For-profit
[ ] Non-profit
[ ] Hybrid (both entities)
Choose one.

A4. Legal registration
[ ] Pvt. Limited
[ ] Section 42
[ ] Trust
[ ] Society
[ ] SMC-Pvt Ltd
[ ] US 501(c)(3)
[ ] Other
[ ] Registration in progress
Choose one.
If Other: please specify (max 60 characters).

A5. Year first registered
YYYY. The entity that runs the programme you are applying with.

A6. Headquarters city and country
Max 60 characters.

A7. Where you currently operate
Only places where you have active users today. Not places you plan to enter.
[ ] Punjab
[ ] Sindh
[ ] KP
[ ] Balochistan
[ ] ICT
[ ] AJK
[ ] GB
[ ] Outside Pakistan
Choose all that apply.
If Outside Pakistan: please specify (max 60 characters).

A8. Sector
Pick the one where your primary outcome sits.
[ ] Education & ECD
[ ] Health
[ ] Livelihoods & Employment
[ ] Financial Inclusion
[ ] Water & Sanitation
[ ] Agriculture & Food
[ ] Energy
[ ] Climate & Conservation
[ ] Other

Choose one.

A9. Website
Enter "none" if you do not have one.

A10. Total annual budget, most recent complete financial year, USD
Total expenditure, not income. Whole numbers only — no commas or decimals.
Digits only. Or tick: [ ] We don't track this.

A11. Full-time staff today
Full-time equivalents on your payroll. Exclude volunteers and government staff. Whole numbers only — no commas or decimals.
Digits only.

A12. Part-time, contract and field staff today
Whole numbers only — no commas or decimals.
Digits only.

Section B — Applicant

B1. Full name
Max 80 characters.

B2. Role title
Max 60 characters.

B3. Email

B4. Phone, with country code

B5. LinkedIn
Enter "none" if you do not have one.

Section C — Where you actually are today

C1. Which single statement is true of your product or programme today?

Choose the highest statement that is fully true today, not the one you expect to be true in three months. If two feel true, choose the lower one.

[ ] We have designed it. Nothing has been built or delivered yet.
[ ] We have built it. No one outside our own team has used it yet.
[ ] It is in pilot: real users are using it, in a small number of sites, under our direct day-to-day supervision.
[ ] It runs at steady state in one geography, without the founder involved day to day.
[ ] It runs at steady state in more than one geography.
[ ] Someone other than us — a government body or partner organisation — is delivering it using our tools or platform.

Choose one.

C2. The month and year the first person outside your organisation used what you built

Not the month you registered, not the month you started building. The first real user.

C3. Complete this sentence

The number is people using it today — not a cumulative total and not a target. The user category is the person who touches it directly: if a teacher uses your tool and her students benefit, your category is teachers. Give the definition of "active" you really use, including the time window.

As of today, [number — max 9] [user category — max 25] are actively using [what they are using — max 60] . We count someone as active if [your definition — max 150] .

C4. Your three largest delivery sites or partners

Name them — "a government partner in Punjab" is not an answer we can use. Multiple countries: fill it country-wise. Pakistan only: site-wise.

Up to 3 rows. Columns: Name of the site, district or partner | Users there today | Working with them since (MM/YYYY).

C5. What does a user actually interact with?

[ ] A physical product
[ ] A mobile app
[ ] WhatsApp, SMS or voice
[ ] A web platform or dashboard
[ ] In-person training or a curriculum
[ ] A financial product
[ ] A service delivered face to face by a person
[ ] Other

Choose all that apply.

If Other: please specify (max 40 characters).

Section D — The problem

D1. Who are your users?

Demographics only — do not describe the problems they face here. Cover age range, gender split, income level, rural/peri-urban/urban, occupation, education, language.
Max 500 characters.

D2. Name the problems you address

Only what you are addressing today. "Lack of empowerment" is not a problem a person experiences. "A mother walks 4km to the nearest clinic and is turned away twice out of three visits" is.
Up to 3 rows. Columns: The problem, as something a person experiences | How many people in your country face it | Where that number comes from ("we don't track this" allowed for counts).

Section E — The intervention and how it works

E1. Describe the intervention. What happens, in the order it happens.
Describe only what happens. If a sentence does not describe an action someone takes, delete it.
Max 600 characters.

E2a. Walk one user through it — first contact
How does a user find out about you and get started?
Max 200 characters.

E2b. Walk one user through it — the core interaction
What does the user do, how often, for how long each time?
Max 200 characters.

E2c. Walk one user through it — the end
What is different for that user when they are done?
Max 200 characters.

E3. Complete this chain
The last blank should name the same thing as your primary metric in Section F.
We do [what you do — max 120] !’ which causes [the user — max 120] to do [what they do — max 120] differently !’ which produces [the outcome — max 120] !’ which we measure as [your measure — max 120] .

Section F — Evidence

F1. Which statement describes your strongest evidence today?

A study in progress is not a study completed, and a study you are running yourself is not an independent one. We select organisations at every level on this list. What we cannot work with is a claim we cannot place on it.

[ ] 1. User testimonials and anecdotes
[ ] 2. Usage or output data only — how much we delivered, and to whom
[ ] 3. Before-and-after outcome data on our own users, with no comparison group
[ ] 4. Outcome data with a non-randomised comparison group
[ ] 5. A randomised or quasi-experimental study we are running ourselves, in progress
[ ] 6. A randomised or quasi-experimental study we ran ourselves, completed, results in hand
[ ] 7. An independent third-party evaluation, completed — not an RCT
[ ] 8. An RCT by an independent third party, in progress
[ ] 9. An RCT by an independent third party, completed, results in hand

Choose one.

F2. Your single best outcome result

One row. Every cell is required.
Up to 1 row. Columns: What was measured | The result (number and unit) | Sample size | What it was compared against | Who measured it (organisation or person, by name) | When (MM/YYYY) | Public link, or "not public".

F3. What is your primary metric?

One number, not a list. An outcome, not an output — "teachers trained" is an output; "percentage of Grade 3 students reading at grade level" is an outcome. State the unit. If your primary metric is currently an output, say so plainly and give it anyway.
Max 120 characters.

F4. How do you measure it?

Instrument or method; frequency; who collects it, by name; the sample or population; whether you have a baseline.
Max 500 characters.

Section G — Scale: who does it, who pays for it

G1. Complete this sentence

The two blanks can be the same, and they can both be you — legitimate if you are a business. What they cannot be is "partners" or "the ecosystem".

At scale, [named entity or type of entity — max 80] delivers this, and [named entity or type of entity — max 80] pays for it.

G2. What will be your primary mechanism for reaching 1M+ users by 2030?

Examples: Digital Platform (App/SMS/Voice), Government Partnership/Adoption, Training of Trainers, Human Delivery, B2B Partnerships, Enterprise Sales.
Max 40 characters.

G3. Scale. What is your path or strategy to reach 1M users by 2030? Ideally, who would pay for user #1,000,001 — a government, a market, or a donor?

The longest answer we ask for anywhere. Spend it on specifics rather than ambition: the institutions you need by name and where each relationship actually stands today; what has to happen for the next one to say yes; the numbers you expect by 2027, 2028 and 2030; and who pays once donor money is out of the picture. "We will partner with government and scale nationally" tells us nothing.
Max 1100 characters.

Section H — How you found us

H1. How did you hear about the fellowship?
[ ] Website
[ ] Social media
[ ] Referred by another organisation
[ ] Email from Taleemabad
[ ] A funder
[ ] A previous fellow
[ ] Other
Choose one.
If Referred by another organisation / Other: please specify (max 80 characters).

H2. Anything we should know that no question above let you tell us? (optional)
Optional. Not a place to restate your case; it is for context that has no home in the questions above.
Max 400 characters.

Confirmation

[ ] Every number in this application is one I can show you the source for. I understand that shortlisted applicants have a 45-minute conversation with the Mulago and Taleemabad team, and that the conversation starts from these answers.